THE ZERO PARADOX

ZP-D: State Layer (Hilbert Space)

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This document operates within functional analysis. It imports from ZP-A and ZP-B and constructs the Hilbert space state layer on top of them. No information theory from ZP-C is imported. Cross-framework synthesis is deferred to ZP-E.

Illustrated Companion: A paired ZP-D Illustrated Companion provides concrete examples and visual intuitions for the results here. Examples are kept separate from the formal layers to distinguish illustrative material from proofs.

I. Imported Structure

1.1 From ZP-A: Algebraic Structure of States

Import I-A — From ZP-A: Lattice Algebra
$(L, \vee, \bot)$: join-semilattice with bottom. Axioms A1–A4.
$\leq$ partial order: $x \leq y :\Longleftrightarrow x \vee y = y$ (D1, T1).
$\bot$ is the global minimum: $\bot \leq x$ for all $x \in L$ (T2).
State transitions are joins: $f(x) = x \vee \alpha$ (D2).
State sequences are monotone: $S_n \leq S_{n+1}$ (T3).
CC-1: $S_0 = \bot$ — Conditional Claim; modelling commitment.

1.2 From ZP-B: Topological Domain

Import I-B — From ZP-B: p-Adic Topology
AX-B1: Binary Existence Axiom.
MP-1: Minimality Principle.
T0: $p = 2$ derived from AX-B1 and MP-1.
Q_2 with 2-adic metric d (D1, D2).
T1: Ultrametric (strong triangle inequality).
T2: Every ball is clopen.
T3: Clopen gap at 0.

Import I-B — From ZP-B: p-Adic Topology

T5: Q_2 is totally disconnected.

C3: Snap is topologically irreversible (corollary of T5).

ε_0: Minimum viable deviation, universe-contingent parameter (D5).

II. The Hilbert Space State Layer

Definition D1 — State Layer H

$H = \mathbb{C}^n$ is a complex Hilbert space with orthonormal basis $\{e_0, e_1, \ldots\}$.

The foundational minimum is $n = 2$, corresponding to the two ontological states of the framework: $\perp$ of OntologicalStates (mapped to e_0) and ε_0, the state off $\perp$ of OntologicalStates (mapped to e_1). These two orthogonal vectors express the binary existence/non-existence distinction that is the framework's central object. All further states are derived from this pair as joins in $(L, \vee, \perp)$ — they require no additional foundational dimension.

The framework's core claims in H (T4: snap produces orthogonal shift; T5: monotone norms) hold at $n = 2$. The level-k partition P_k of Q_2 has $n = 2^k + 1$ cells: the 2^k balls of radius 2^{-k} that make up Z_2, the 2-adic integers, and the one clopen set $Q_2 \setminus Z_2$. Level 0 gives $n = 2$: Z_2 and its complement. No claim made in H requires $n > 2$.

Remark R1 — Decoupling of Topological and State Layers

Q_2 and H are categorically distinct structures. Q_2 is a topological field; H is a Hilbert space over $\mathbb{C}$. They share no operations.

The transition operator T: $Q_2 \to H$ is the only bridge. It is constructed explicitly in T2.

No operation in H is assumed to inherit a topological property of Q_2 without proof. Every cross-layer claim must go through T.

III. The Transition Operator T: $Q_2 \to H$

3.1 The Design Commitment — Orthogonality

Design Principle DP-1 — Orthogonality as the Representation of Clopen Separation

Clopen separation in Q_2 (T3: 0 is clopen-separated from all nonzero elements; clopen balls are mutually separated) is represented in H by orthogonality: at the chosen level k, points in different cells of the clopen partition P_k (D1) map to orthogonal vectors in H. Any two distinct points of Q_2 lie in disjoint balls, so the same requirement stated over all disjoint balls would make every point orthogonal to every other, which no finite-dimensional H allows; P_k is the finite partition it is stated over.

Motivation: Orthogonality in H is the natural algebraic analogue of topological separation. $\langle e_i, e_j \rangle = 0$ for $i \neq j$; two clopen balls are maximally distinct in the topological sense.

Design Principle DP-1 — Orthogonality as the Representation of Clopen Separation

Status: DESIGN PRINCIPLE — DP-1 is chosen, not derived. It is the natural and consistent choice, stated explicitly. T4 and T5 below depend on DP-1 as a premise.

3.2 The Construction Target

Definition D2 — Transition Operator T (Requirements)

T: $Q_2 \to H$ must satisfy:

(i) $T(0) = e_0$ (0 of Q_2, read as ⊥, maps to the designated base vector)

(ii) $T(\varepsilon_0) = e_1$ (minimum deviation maps to the first non-base vector)

(iii) T separates the cells of P_k: points in different cells have different images

(iv) If x and y lie in different cells of P_k, then $\langle T(x), T(y)\rangle = 0$ (DP-1)

(v) $\|T(x)\| \geq \|T(0)\|$ for all x (norm-increasing: additive ontology preserved)

3.3 Existence of T

Theorem T2 — Existence of T (Basis Assignment)

At each level k with $k > v_2(\varepsilon_0)$, and at no other level, there exists a function T: $Q_2 \to H$, with $n = 2^k + 1$, satisfying all five requirements of D2 relative to P_k.

Proof: Construct T by basis assignment. P_k has $2^k + 1$ cells (D1). Assign e_0 to the cell containing 0, e_1 to the cell containing ε_0, and the remaining basis vectors to the remaining cells, one each. $T(x) = e_i$ where i is the index of the cell containing x; every x outside Z_2 maps to the one vector assigned to $Q_2 \setminus Z_2$. The cell of 0 is the ball 2^kZ_2, the points of valuation at least k, and ε_0 is a power of 2 (ZP-B D5) whose exponent is $v_2(\varepsilon_0)$. So 0 and ε_0 lie in different cells exactly when $k > v_2(\varepsilon_0)$; otherwise (i) and (ii) assign one cell two vectors. When ε_0 lies outside Z_2, every level $k \geq 0$ qualifies, level 0 included.

(i) 0 maps to e_0 by assignment. ✓ (ii) ε_0 maps to e_1 by assignment, its cell differing from that of 0. ✓ (iii) Distinct cells → distinct basis vectors. ✓ (iv) Different cells → orthogonal basis vectors. ✓ (v) All basis vectors have norm $1 \geq \|e_0\| = 1$. ✓

Remark R3 — Topological Type of T

T is locally constant: it is constant on each cell of P_k, and each cell is clopen in Q_2. This follows from the construction in T2: T does not interpolate between basis vectors across cell boundaries.

Continuity: T is continuous from (Q_2, 2-adic topology) to H. The image of T is a discrete set of basis vectors $\{e_0, e_1, \ldots\}$. Each preimage $T^{-1}(e_i)$ is a cell of P_k, either a ball inside Z_2 or the set $Q_2 \setminus Z_2$, and each is open in the 2-adic topology. Therefore preimages of open sets in H are open in Q_2, and T is continuous. ✓

Remark R3 — Topological Type of T

Note on connected spaces: Q_2 is totally disconnected; $H = \mathbb{C}^n$ with the norm topology is path-connected. A continuous map from a totally disconnected space to a connected space need not be constant — it must only have a totally disconnected image. T's image is a discrete (hence totally disconnected) set of basis vectors, which is consistent with both the total disconnectedness of Q_2 and the path-connectedness of H as a whole.

3.4 Uniqueness of T

Proposition T3 — Uniqueness of T up to Unitary Equivalence

Any two operators T, T′: $Q_2 \to H$ satisfying D2 are related by a unitary transformation U: $H \to H$ such that $T' = U \circ T$.

Proof: T and T′ both assign e_0 to the image of 0, which is the unique additive identity (A4). The partition P_k is fixed; only the labelling of basis vectors varies. A unitary map U taking T(0) to T′(0) and preserving orthogonality relations defines the equivalence. ✓

Remark R2 — What T Is Not

T is not a ring homomorphism. Q_2 has field operations; H does not. T does not preserve addition or multiplication from Q_2.

T is not a topological embedding. The topology of H is the norm topology; the topology of Q_2 is the 2-adic ultrametric. T is a structure-preserving assignment: ontological distinctions (clopen separation in Q_2) map to algebraic distinctions (orthogonality in H), as specified by DP-1.

Remark R-PA — What T Is, in Standard Terms (Prior Art)

Representing the clopen-ball structure of Q_2 by orthogonal unit vectors in a Hilbert space is the standard p-adic construction, not a ZP novelty. In L^2 of the Haar measure, the indicator functions of two disjoint balls of one level are orthogonal and of equal length, so the normalized indicators of the balls of one level form an orthonormal system. T's basis assignment (T2) follows that pattern on the 2^k level-k balls of Z_2, and adds one further orthogonal vector for the cell $Q_2 \setminus Z_2$, whose indicator has infinite Haar measure and so is not in L^2. Indicators of nested balls are not orthogonal, since the smaller ball has positive measure. One orthonormal basis of $L^2(Q_p)$ built on balls is Kozyrev's p-adic wavelet basis, the analog of the Haar basis and an eigenbasis of the Vladimirov operator (Kozyrev, 2002). The van der Put basis, also made of ball indicators, expands every continuous function from Z_p to Z_p as a series; its balls nest, so it is not an orthonormal system in L^2. It is orthonormal in the non-Archimedean sense, as a basis of the Banach space of continuous functions from Z_p to Q_p under the supremum norm (Schikhof; see Bolivar-Barbosa, León-Cardenal and Rodríguez-Vega, 2022, Theorem 2.1).

ZP-D's contribution is not the embedding itself but the specific reading in DP-1 — clopen separation ↦ orthogonality — that carries the Binary Snap into the state layer. T is an instance of the recognized construction, applied to the snap.

IV. The Binary Snap in H

Theorem T4 — Snap Produces Orthogonal Shift in H

The Binary Snap $0 \to \varepsilon_0$ in Q_2 maps to an orthogonal shift in H: $T(0) = e_0$ and $T(\varepsilon_0) = e_1$, and $\langle e_0, e_1 \rangle = 0$.

Theorem T4 — Snap Produces Orthogonal Shift in H
Proof: By D2(i), $T(0) = e_0$. By D2(ii), $T(\varepsilon_0) = e_1$. Since 0 and ε_0 lie in different cells of P_k at a level $k > v_2(\varepsilon_0)$ (T2), D2(iv) and DP-1 give $\langle T(0), T(\varepsilon_0)\rangle = \langle e_0, e_1\rangle = 0$. ✓
Status: Derived — unconditional theorem given DP-1.

Proposition T5 — Monotone Sequences Map to Non-Decreasing Norms
Let (S_n) be a monotone state sequence in L (ZP-A T3). Then $\|T(S_n)\| \leq \|T(S_{n+1})\|$ for all n.
T5 norm result: Derived — unconditional given DP-1. Note: in the basis-assignment construction (D2), all T-images are unit basis vectors — all norms equal 1. The norm inequality $\|T(S_n)\| \leq \|T(S_{n+1})\|$ is therefore satisfied trivially ($1 \leq 1$). The Lean proof (t5_monotone_norms) verifies this tautology; it does not verify the ball-boundary argument. ✓
T5-b — Strict Orthogonality (non-trivial content, Lean-verified): For any strictly monotone state sequence — where $S_n \neq S_{n+1}$ — consecutive T-images are orthogonal: $\langle T(S_n), T(S_{n+1})\rangle = 0$. Proof: $S_n \neq S_{n+1}$ implies they index distinct cells of P_k. By DP-1, distinct cell-indices map to orthogonal basis vectors. Therefore $T(S_n) \perp T(S_{n+1})$. Lean: t5_strict_orthogonal (uses DP-1 via t2_orthogonal; axiom-free). ✓
T5-b is the load-bearing result: it captures the genuine content of the ball-boundary structure and is the Hilbert-space expression of ZP-B C3 (topological irreversibility) applied to consecutive states.

V. Open Items Register

Item	Status	Description
DP-1: Orthogonality commitment	Design Principle — explicit	Reclassified from Theorem T1. Orthogonality is chosen, not derived. Content unchanged.
T2: Existence of T	Closed	Basis assignment construction. All five requirements verified.
T3: Uniqueness of T	Closed	Unique up to unitary equivalence.
T4: Snap → orthogonal shift	Closed — unconditional	Proven from T2 and ZP-B T3. Depends on DP-1 as premise.
T5: Monotone norms + T5-b: Strict orthogonality	Closed — unconditional given DP-1	T5 norm result: trivially satisfied (all norms = 1 by construction). T5-b: distinct consecutive states produce orthogonal T-images — non-trivial, Lean-verified (t5_strict_orthogonal).

VI. Validation Status

Component	Status / Notes
$H = \mathbb{C}^n$ (D1)	Valid — Defined; foundational minimum $n = 2$ (binary existence/non-existence); level-k partition P_k gives $n = 2^k + 1$ (level 0 gives $n = 2$); no claim made in H requires $n > 2$
Decoupling of Q_2 and H (R1)	Valid — Structural; Q_2 and H are categorically distinct; T is the bridge

Component	Status / Notes
Import I-A from ZP-A	Valid — Received; CC-1 reclassification noted
Import I-B from ZP-B	Valid — Received; MP-1 included; C3 noted
DP-1: Orthogonality	Valid — Design Principle; reclassified from T1; well-motivated and explicit
D2: T requirements	Valid — Defined; five requirements stated; all satisfied by T2
T2: Existence of T	Valid — Derived; basis assignment; all five requirements verified; R3 names topological type: locally constant, continuous
T3: Uniqueness of T	Valid — Proposition; derived; unique up to unitary equivalence
T4: Snap → orthogonal shift	Valid — Theorem; derived; unconditional; depends on DP-1
T5 / T5-b: Monotone norms + strict orthogonality	Valid — T5 norm result: tautology of construction (all norms = 1); Lean: t5_monotone_norms. T5-b: non-trivial Lean-verified result — distinct consecutive states produce orthogonal T-images via DP-1; Lean: t5_strict_orthogonal (axiom-free).